Mini-Research 7

Integrated Laser–AuNP–Bubble Model: Self-Consistent Dynamics and Peak Gas Temperature

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Abstract

I couple a closed, fixed-composition gas and Keller–Miksis mechanics to conservative radial heat transport in material water volumes and dynamic gold nanoparticle storage. One signed current-state gas–liquid flux closes both energy equations; no precomputed transfer efficiency enters. A 10 ns, 10 J/m^2 pulse absorbed by one 20 nm-radius Au particle under prescribed near-wall confinement raises the computed five-cycle maximum by about 1.41 and 2.18 microkelvin at 1.0 and 1.15 bar. The former is a conditional reduced-model result; the latter is a formal fixed-composition scenario, despite completing five numerical cycles. Feedback respectively increases and reduces the one-way effect. The wet 1.3 bar trajectory is coefficient-censored; dry formal variants retain higher temperatures. Spherical source averaging substantially underpredicts local Au heating. Numerical completion does not establish a validated physical gas state, realizable nanoparticle environment or fusion condition.

1 Question and model hierarchy

The question is whether laser energy absorbed in a small local number of gold nanoparticles reaches an acoustically compressed gas early enough to change its maximum temperature. Delayed heat may miss the thermal maximum, while an earlier pulse can change subsequent pressure and compression work. I do not select parameters to obtain a desired peak.

The inherited state is $R_0 = 6\,\mu$m, $T_0 = 293.15\,$K, $f = 30$ kHz and $p_0 = 101325$ Pa. I request five periods, $I = [0, 166.667]\,\mu$s. Acoustic amplitudes are 1.0, 1.15 and 1.3 bar. Level 0 recovers the previous clamped-water gas closure. Level 1 denotes the preceding frozen-geometry diagnostic, retained solely as context. Level 2 evolves gas, water and gold on prescribed no-laser mechanics. Level 3 evolves the full reduced state together and supplies the principal paired comparison.

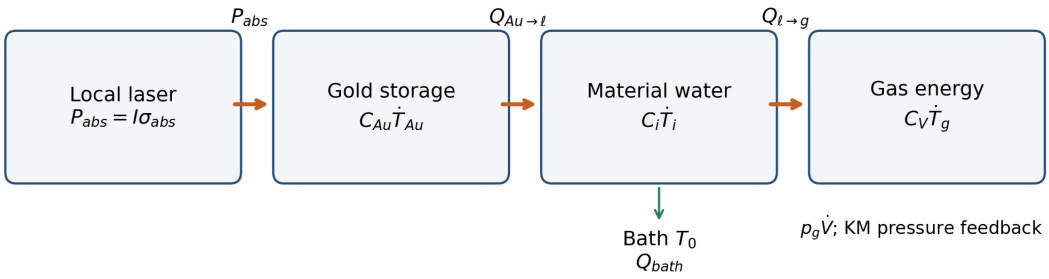


Figure 1: Energy directions and state coupling. A radial shell source represents an angular average; it is not a resolved local Au temperature field.

2 Moving liquid in a material coordinate

The first-order incompressible radial field is

$$u_\ell(r,t) = R^2 U/r^2, \qquad U = \dot{R}, \quad r \geq R. \tag{1}$$

Define $\xi = (r^3 - R^3)/3$, so $r(\xi,t) = (R^3 + 3\xi)^{1/3}$. Along a liquid particle,

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}\xi}{\mathrm{d}t} = r^2 u_\ell - R^2 U = 0, \qquad \left.\frac{\partial r}{\partial t}\right|_\xi = \frac{R^2 U}{r^2}. \tag{2}$$

Thus the Eulerian material derivative becomes $\partial_t|_\xi$. Since $\partial_r = r^2 \partial_\xi$, the constant-property energy equation transforms as

$$\rho_\ell c_\ell (\partial_t T_\ell + u_\ell \partial_r T_\ell) = \frac{1}{r^2}\partial_r (k_\ell r^2 \partial_r T_\ell) + q_{Au}, \tag{3}$$

$$\rho_\ell c_\ell \left.\partial_t T_\ell\right|_\xi = \partial_\xi (k_\ell r^4 \partial_\xi T_\ell) + q_{Au}. \tag{4}$$

Here $[\xi] = \mathrm{m}^3$, $[k_\ell r^4 \partial_\xi T] = \mathrm{W}$ and the divergence has units $\mathrm{W/m^3}$. The volume element is $\mathrm{d}V_\ell = 4\pi \mathrm{d}\xi$. A fixed material cell therefore has constant positive capacity

$$C_i = 4\pi \rho_\ell c_\ell (\xi_{i+1/2} - \xi_{i-1/2}). \tag{5}$$

Geometric motion changes thermal resistance, not cell mass or capacity.

For neighboring centers at their *current* radii, exact spherical steady resistance gives

$$K_{i,i+1} = \frac{4\pi k_\ell}{1/r_i - 1/r_{i+1}}, \qquad J_{i+1/2} = K_{i,i+1}(T_i - T_{i+1}). \tag{6}$$

J is positive outward. The semidiscrete equation is

$$C_i \dot{T}_i = J_{i-1/2} - J_{i+1/2} + \sum_j w_{ij} Q_{Au_j \to \ell}, \tag{7}$$

with $J_{1/2} = -Q_{\ell \to g}$ and $J_{n+1/2} = Q_{bath}$. Every interior transfer cancels exactly when cells are summed. At the outer material face, a separately evaluated half-cell resistance connects the last cell to a bath at T_0. The external radius moves with the liquid. Doubling its initial padding tests finite-domain influence.

The constants are $\rho_\ell c_\ell = 1000 \times 4187$ J/(m^3 K) and $k_\ell = 0.6$ W/(m K), following the optical thermal study [4]. Mechanical water constants retain their earlier values, including $\rho = 998.2$ kg/m^3 and $c = 1482$ m/s. This small reference-property distinction is explicit. Incompressible transport is conditional at high Mach number; coordinate conservation does not repair its physical approximation.

For an unobstructed spherical liquid domain, radial velocity and a prescribed source, angular averaging removes the angular Laplacian because its integral over the closed sphere is zero. The radial equation then describes the exact monopole of that prescribed-source problem. The approximation here enters through finite-Au exclusion, its nonuniform surface heat release and the replacement of local Au-adjacent water by a spherical mean. Agreement of an integrated gas flux cannot validate those local quantities.

3 One signed interface, gas energy and mechanical feedback

The effective gas conductance is $H_g = 4\pi R^2 h_g$ with $h_g = \eta k_g/R$, $\eta = 1$ nominal. This is a reduced gas transport parameter, not a measured molecular interface conductance. A half-cell liquid resistance K_w^{-1} reconstructs the wall temperature:

$$Q_{\ell\to g} = \frac{T_1 - T_g}{H_g^{-1} + K_w^{-1}}, \qquad T_{\ell,w} = T_g + Q_{\ell\to g}/H_g. \tag{8}$$

Positive $Q_{\ell\to g}$ heats the gas; negative flux heats water. The identical power enters the water equation with opposite sign. In the zero-h_g limit it vanishes. In the separately imposed limit $T_{\ell,w} = T_0$, it becomes $-4\pi\eta k_g R(T_g - T_0)$, exactly the previous closure. That old heat loss is *replaced*, not added. Neither the frozen reference baseline nor the frozen reference sum is added.

The gas keeps the accepted fixed inventory and NASA9 caloric law [2]:

$$V = 4\pi R^3/3, \qquad p_g = nR_u T_g/V, \tag{9}$$

$$C_V^{tot}(T_g)\dot{T}_g = -p_g\dot{V} + Q_{\ell\to g}, \qquad \Delta U_g = n\int_{T_0}^{T_g} c_V(T)\,\mathrm{d}T. \tag{10}$$

Initial total pressure is $p_0 + 2\sigma/R_0$. H_2O is already part of the inventory; no additional fixed vapor pressure appears. Air-like dry fractions are 79/21 N_2/O_2; the initial vapor mole fraction follows the inherited saturated-pressure ratio. Nominal k_g is 0.0264 W/(m K), or 0.0177 for argon, held fixed as a model sensitivity.

Differentiating $\ln p_g = \ln(nR_u) + \ln T_g - \ln V$ at constant composition gives

$$\dot{p}_g = p_g(\dot{T}_g/T_g - 3U/R). \tag{11}$$

With $p_\infty = p_0 - P_a \sin\omega t$, $\omega = 2\pi f$, the inherited full viscous Keller–Miksis form [1] is

$$D\dot{U} = (1 + U/c)\Delta p/\rho + RB/(\rho c) - \tfrac{3}{2}(1 - U/(3c))U^2, \tag{12}$$

$$\Delta p = p_g - p_\infty - 2\sigma/R - 4\mu U/R, \tag{13}$$

$$B = \dot{p}_g + 2\sigma U/R^2 + P_a\omega\cos\omega t + 4\mu U^2/R^2, \tag{14}$$

$$D = R(1 - U/c) + 4\mu/(\rho c). \tag{15}$$

The viscous acceleration derivative belongs in D. Substituting a polytropic $p_g(R)$ would break the present energy feedback. Level 2 keeps prescribed baseline R, U; Level 3 updates them with the heated gas pressure. Their difference measures feedback within this model, subject to numerical and reduction uncertainty.

4 Gold, optical energy and particle motion

Each particle absorbs local power $P_{abs} = \sigma_{abs}(a, \lambda, n_m) I_{local}$. The accepted Mie implementation uses the unchanged Johnson–Christy table [3] and a real water host $n_m = 1.33$. Local fluence already includes optical delivery; attenuation is not applied twice. The nominal $a = 20$ nm, $\lambda = 532$ nm cross section is $3.43373245 \times 10^{-15}$ m^2. A 10 ns top hat at $F = 10$ J/m^2 absorbs 34.3373 fJ per particle.

$$C_{Au}\dot{T}_{Au} = P_{abs} - Q_{Au\to\ell}, \quad C_{Au} = \tfrac{4}{3}\pi a^3 \rho_{Au} c_{Au}, \quad Q_{Au\to\ell} = 4\pi a^2 G(T_{Au} - \overline{T}_\ell). \tag{16}$$

Nominal $G = 10^8$ W/(m^2 K), $\rho_{Au} = 19320$ kg/m^3 and $c_{Au} = 129$ J/(kg K). I evolve this capacity rather than inject all absorbed energy instantaneously into gas or water. Electron–phonon relaxation and Au internal diffusion require an adequately long pulse [4]; hotter or ultrashort cases need additional physics.

For a finite Au surface at center radius r_{np}, angular averaging gives radial probability density $r/(2r_{np}a)$ on $[r_{np} - a, r_{np} + a]$. I integrate it against piecewise linear water reconstruction functions, obtaining positive weights w_i with $\sum_i w_i = 1$. Then $\overline{T}_\ell = \sum_i w_i T_i$ and the same adjoint weights deposit $w_i Q_{Au\to\ell}$. This counts energy exactly once, but spreads the particle's source around the bubble and omits its excluded water volume and local angular spreading resistance. It cannot certify a local water maximum or nanoparticle material screen.

Passive motion satisfies $r_{np}^3 - R^3 = \text{const}$. Fixed laboratory centers and prescribed confinement $r_{np} = R + a + d_0$ are distinct controls. The latter has no derived retaining force. The surface gap is always $d = r_{np} - R - a$; contact terminates a branch before source continuation into gas. Multiple particles occupy an angularly separated ring normal to a broad local beam. Their count is not a number density. Projected separation and $N\sigma_{ext}/A_{beam}$ screen overlap and photon allowance; near-wall optical changes remain unresolved.

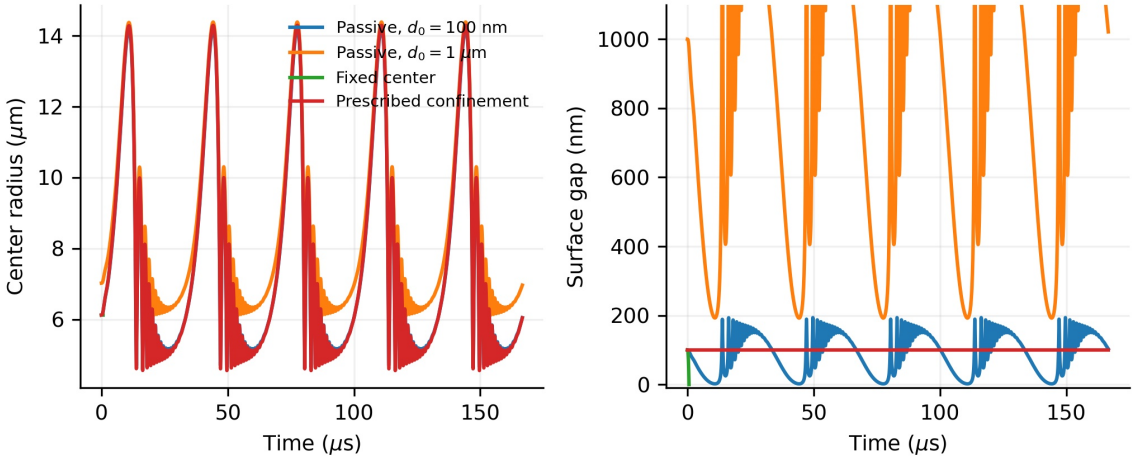


Figure 2: Particle positions and surface gaps for passive, fixed and prescribed confinement. A stopped curve marks contact, not a continued liquid-only solution.

5 Observation intervals and event timing

I distinguish the first strong local radius minimum ($R < R_0/2$), first-cycle deepest minimum, global radius minimum and gas-temperature maximum. In the absence of a strong minimum, the first-cycle deepest minimum defines $t_c^{(0)}$. Refined derivative roots on dense solutions locate extrema; plotted samples do not define them. If censoring precedes every accepted local minimum, an explicitly labeled observed-endpoint timing reference is used for a bounded diagnostic. It is not an unobserved collapse event or a completed-cycle minimum.

Pulse time means its center. The offset is $\Delta t = t_{laser} - t_c^{(0)}$. Every paired run uses that same absolute pulse time. A heated event can shift; the source is never silently recentered on it. Timing scans cover several early, near-event and late centers. At weak heating, source sensitivity is evaluated at the independently selected baseline thermal maximum, so a pulse after that maximum can have exactly zero first-order effect on the global maximum even while it subsequently heats the gas.

$$\Delta T_{max} = \max_{t\in I} T_g^{laser}(t) - \max_{t\in I} T_g^{(0)}(t), \qquad \delta_{rel} = \Delta T_{max}/T_{max}^{(0)}. \tag{17}$$

This is a within-Level-3 comparison. A previous clamped-water baseline paired with a newly dynamic heated run would confound water feedback and laser heating. If either member stops, the five-cycle difference is undefined. A separate diagnostic may compare maxima on $[0, \min(t_{end}^{(0)}, t_{end}^{laser})]$, with an unknown tail. No censored tail is extrapolated.

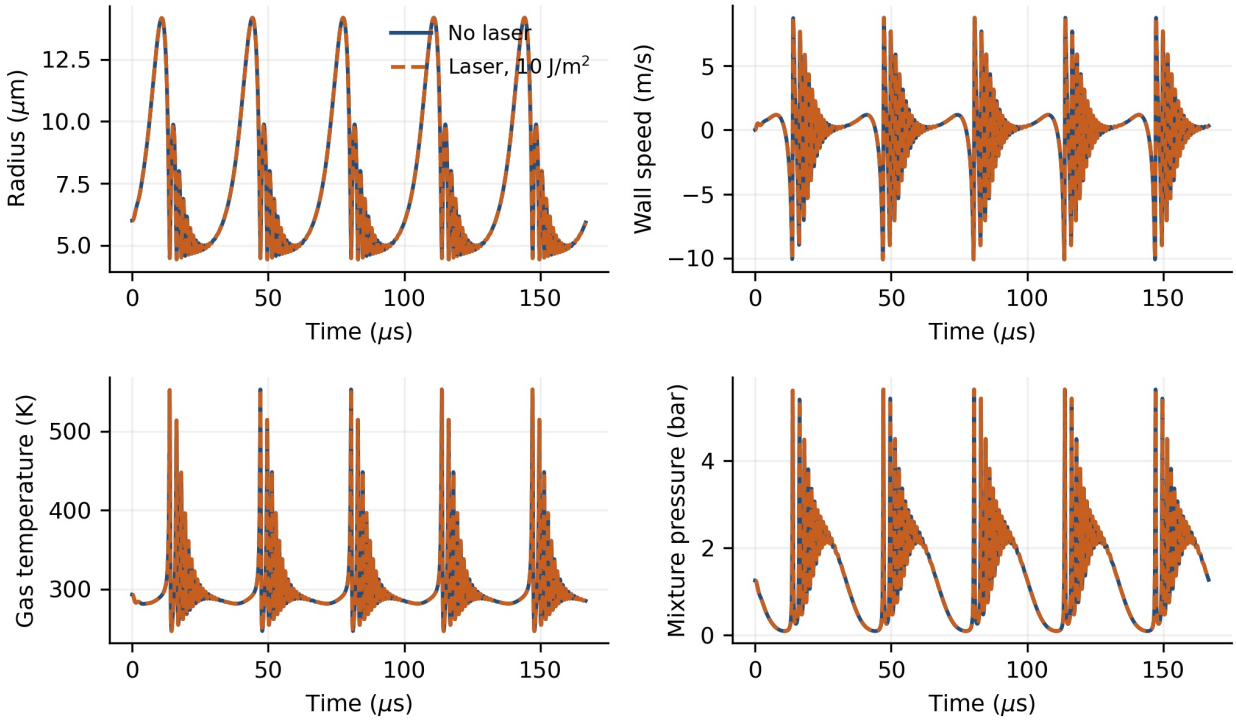


Figure 3: Radius, wall speed, gas temperature and total mixture pressure with and without a pulse. Temperature and radius extrema are calculated separately from the dense solution. The two trajectories nearly overlap at this scale.

6 Stationary benchmark and the cost of source averaging

The moving model has a stationary limit with fixed gas temperature. I match the preceding axisymmetric finite-Au reference at $R = 6\,\mu$m, $a = 20$ nm, $d = 100$ nm, $h = 4400$ W/(m^2 K), $G = 10^8$ W/(m^2 K), 10 ns, 532 nm and $F = 1$ J/m^2. Additional references use a 500 nm gap and near contact ($a = 100$ nm, $d = 1$ nm, $h = 10^6$). Each comparison uses its actual archived absorbed energy and a 2 μs window.

Case	MR6 gas (%)	Radial (%)	Diff. (%)	MR6 Au (K)	Radial Au (K)
reference	0.32578	0.32716	0.4218	2.307	0.6831
far particle	0.13963	0.13969	0.04251	2.307	0.6831
near contact	43.107	43.829	1.676	1.899	0.406

Table 1: Matched 2 microsecond integrated delivery and peak Au temperature rise. Different observables retain their separate discrepancies.

Agreement of total gas energy does not imply agreement of local fields. The angular average reproduces integrated transport well for a point source toward a uniform spherical absorber, but a finite Au surface exchanges heat with a locally nonuniform liquid. The radial reduction removes this local resistance. A similar final gas fraction can coexist with a badly biased Au temperature or early flux. No weight or conductance is fitted to make the references agree. The external domains also differ: spherical material bath versus finite axisymmetric cylinder. At 320 radial cells the integrated delivery discrepancy spans 0.04–1.68%, whereas radial Au peak rises are only 21–30% of the finite-Au reference. Matching the nearest Au-to-bath clearance separately gives gas-delivery differences from −0.031 to 1.51%; the bath shapes still differ. These are observable-specific comparisons, not a universal moving-geometry error bound. An exact transient Robin point-source control has at most 0.326% relative discrepancy at the sampled positive times on the finest grid.

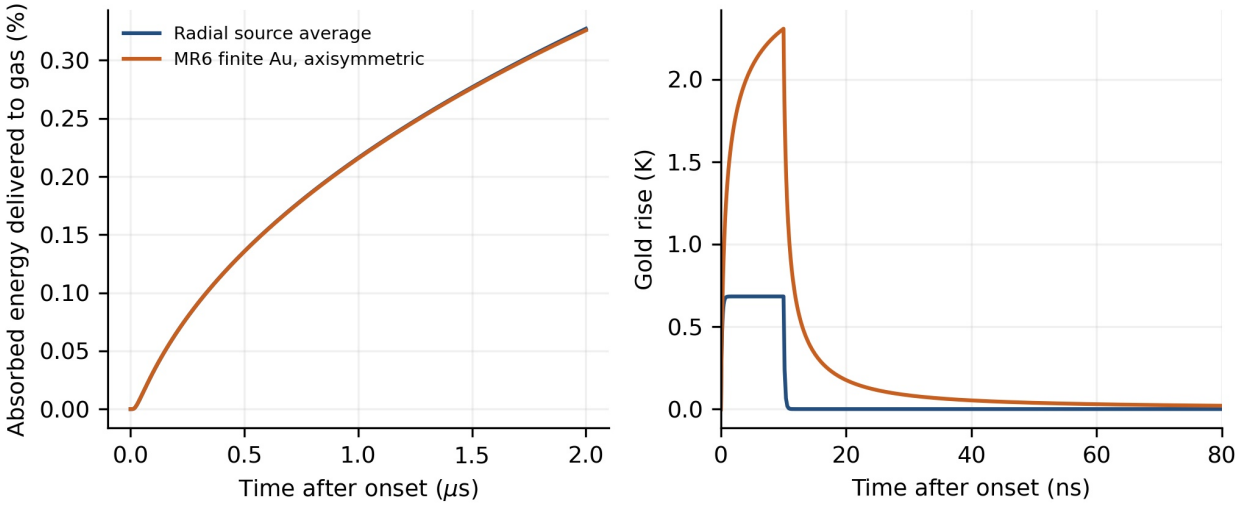


Figure 4: Matched static radial and axisymmetric controls. Integrated delivery and gold temperature are separate observables. Spherical averaging cannot resolve the local Au-adjacent hot spot.

7 Paired temperatures and timing sensitivity

P_a (bar)	T_0^{obs} (K)	T_L^{obs} (K)	ΔT (μK)	t_0 (μs)	t_L (μs)	Numerical completion	Physical applicability
1.00	553.02304	553.02304	1.4088163	147.13186	147.13186	Complete, five cycles	Conditional reduced model; confinement unverified
1.15	2798.2813	2798.2813	2.1848791	16.23774	16.23774	Complete, five cycles	Formal fixed-composition scenario
1.30	6000	5999.9999	*undefined*	18.545314	18.545314	Censored at 6000 K gas-coefficient boundary	Formal, incomplete trajectory

Table 2: Cancellation-controlled nonlinear pairs, F=10 J/m^2, 10 ns, a=20 nm and prescribed 100 nm gap. Completion refers only to the requested integration interval; it does not validate a physical state. Censored observed maxima do not define a five-cycle difference.

The stable nonlinear increment formulation gives 1 bar: $\Delta T_{max} = 1.4088163$ μK, 1.15 bar: $\Delta T_{max} = 2.1848791$ μK, 1.3 bar: no defined five-cycle difference after censoring. Both completed pairs share checked reconstructed references. The 1.00 bar result is conditional on unverified prescribed AuNP confinement. The 1.15 bar result is a formal fixed-composition scenario, not a validated physical gas state. A separate full nonlinear Radau pair at 1.0 bar gives 1.407 microkelvin, without the reconstructed reference. Direct production-tolerance subtraction is unresolved at this scale; its larger differences are retained as numerical diagnostics.

For 1.15 bar the prescribed far-field absolute pressure becomes negative during part of each cycle and computed gas pressure reaches approximately 1.30×10^8 Pa. Fixed composition omits dissociation and ionization; phase change, first-order mechanical accuracy and incompressible liquid transport remain unresolved. Negative liquid pressure alone is not a mathematical proof of impossibility: metastable tension, cavitation and its stability are separate physical questions not resolved here.

The directional variational system includes geometry, two-way heat flow, caloric response and pressure feedback without subtracting nearly equal temperatures. Finite fluences check nonlinearity. A censored-endpoint derivative is not a global-peak derivative; near-tied maxima can destabilize the maximizing time.

The nonlinear paired increment additionally evaluates

$$f(b+\delta) - f(b) = \int_0^1 Df(b+s\delta)\,\delta\,\mathrm{d}s \tag{18}$$

by directional differentiation and three-point Gauss quadrature, checked with five points. Both members share a checked C1 no-laser reconstruction. Cancellation control does not confer microkelvin accuracy on its absolute baseline. Full nonlinear Radau pairs independently check the increment without this reconstruction.

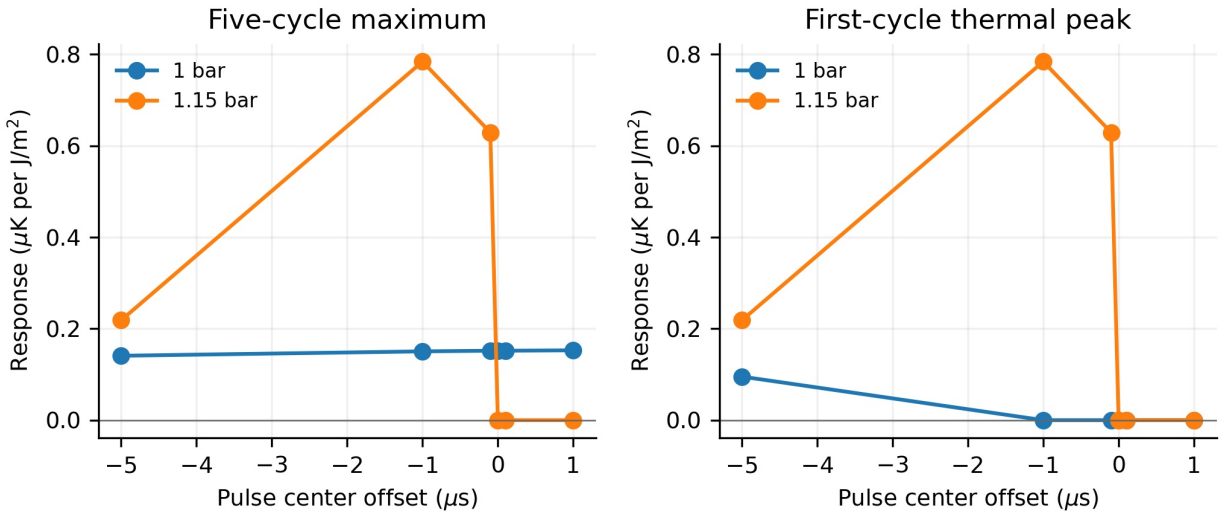


Figure 5: Unit-fluence derivative of the gas-temperature maximum versus pulse-center offset from the no-laser radius event. Global and first-cycle peaks differ. Only complete trajectories enter these curves; censored derivatives are retained separately. This is not a finite-fluence optimum.

8 Moving sources, local sensitivity and feedback

At 1 bar, Level 2 and Level 3 give 0.8578 and 1.409 microkelvin. The additional feedback contribution is 0.551 microkelvin (64.2 percent of the one-way effect). At 1.15 bar, Level 2 and Level 3 give 5.656 and 2.185 microkelvin. The additional feedback contribution is -3.471 microkelvin (-61.4 percent of the one-way effect).

The passive particle can move away from a collapsing wall while approaching it during expansion. A finite particle can consequently contact an expanding wall even when its point-center invariant holds. Prescribed confinement retains heat close to the interface but requires an unmodeled force. Fixed centers can be intercepted before the intended pulse. These geometric distinctions precede any interpretation of a temperature benefit.

The compact one-at-a-time design changes radius, initial gap, count, wavelength, fluence, duration, Au conductance, gas conductance, water conductivity, composition, trapped vapor and pulse center. It is neither a global optimizer nor a proof that these parameters are identifiable. Multiple-particle source averaging additionally omits mutual local thermal fields and optical interactions.

The early 1.15 bar sensitivity changes by about 0.6% under 48-to-96-cell refinement and 0.21% with an independent Radau tangent calculation. The extremely small response to a pulse centered on the selected radius event changes by 89.6% under that mesh refinement (nearly an order of magnitude in the sensitivities). Its sign and size remain unresolved; it is not evidence of a positive late-pulse benefit. At 1.0 bar the first thermal peak precedes the selected radius minimum by about 2.54 microseconds, so even a nominally pre-collapse pulse can miss it.

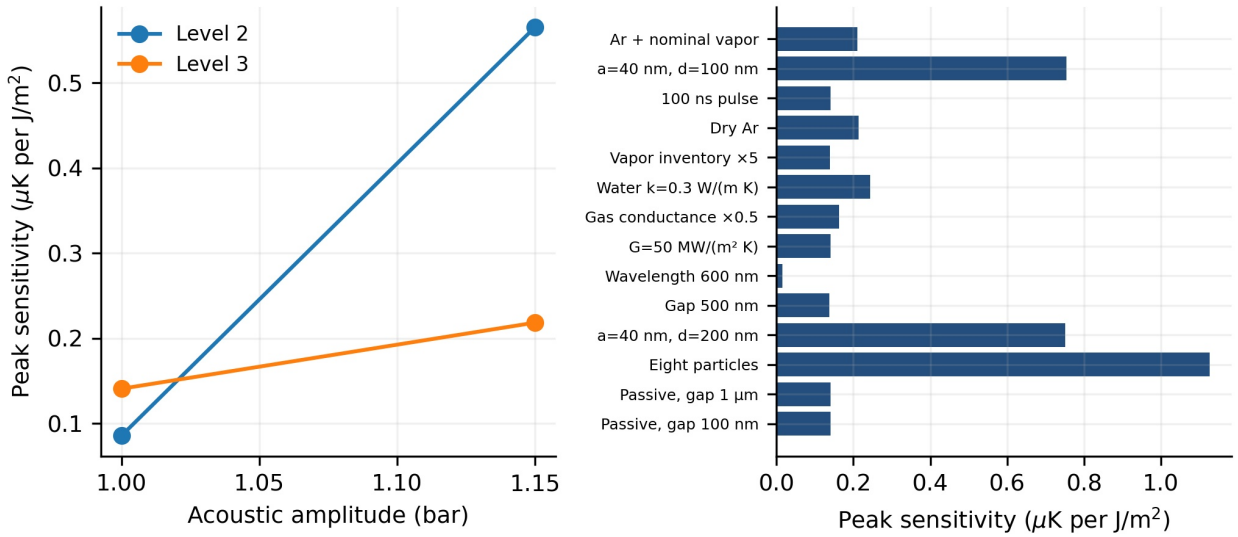


Figure 6: One-way versus coupled sensitivity and the declared motion/parameter controls. Temperature changes are conditional on the specified geometry and source reduction.

9 Thermal conservation and numerical verification

The integrated physical balances are

$$\dot{U}_g = -p_g \dot{V} + Q_{\ell \to g}, \tag{19}$$

$$\dot{E}_\ell = \sum_j Q_{Au_j \to \ell} - Q_{\ell \to g} - Q_{bath}, \tag{20}$$

$$\dot{E}_{Au} = \sum_j P_{abs,j} - \sum_j Q_{Au_j \to \ell}, \tag{21}$$

$$\Delta(U_g + E_\ell + E_{Au}) + W_{by\ gas} + E_{bath} = E_{abs}. \tag{22}$$

Water and Au storage come directly from temperatures and capacities. Work, both exchange powers, bath removal, optical absorption and local incident energy are independently accumulated. Eight-point Gauss integration on accepted intervals checks the ledgers. Positive and negative parts are retained. A returning water flux is not clipped and a bath flux is not defined as a balancing residual.

This is the *thermal subsystem* with mechanical work, not total energy conservation of an acoustically driven fluid. Liquid kinetic energy, imposed acoustic power, viscous dissipation and possible retaining-force work are outside this budget. The laser-induced change in gas energy need not equal the laser energy because compression work also changes. The retained production summaries have maximum scaled total residual 1.83e-06; independent flux quadrature gives 8.98e-06. The cancellation-controlled nonlinear pairs have maximum incremental residual 2.58e-07 of absorbed energy. Spatial, fixed-inner-grid domain extension and time/method controls are separate. The older outer-domain row also changes inner resolution and is not interpreted as a pure boundary test. A direct strict BDF pulse-edge failure is retained; rescaling only the incident-energy ledger tolerance restores completion. Absolute trajectory error is not used to certify a tiny difference.

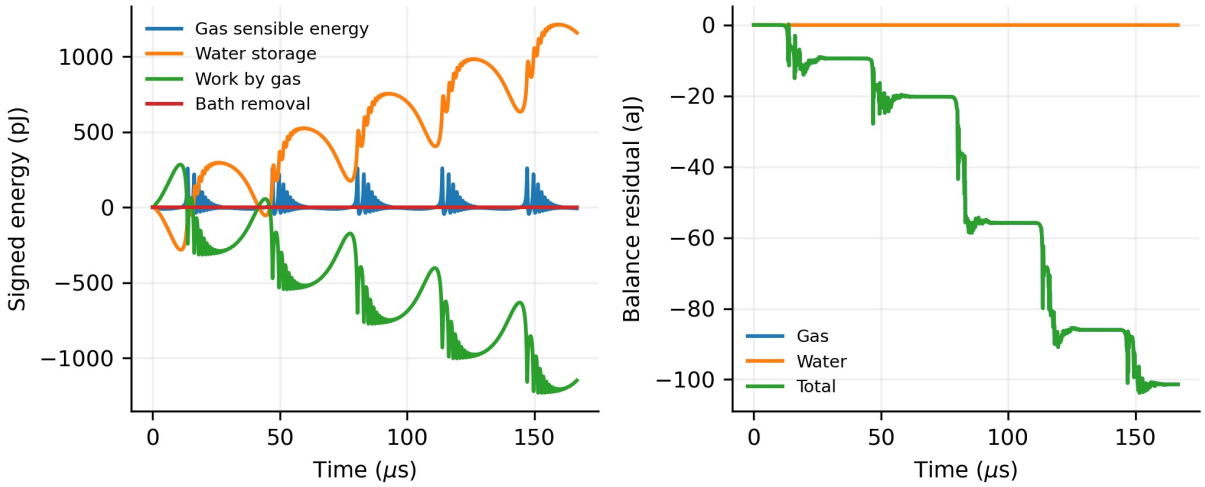


Figure 7: Signed thermal energy channels and residuals. Small residuals verify bookkeeping for the stated equations; they do not validate omitted flow, phase or chemical physics.

10 Coefficient domains, formal extrema and physical interpretation

Wet mixtures stop at 6000 K because that is the archived H_2O coefficient boundary, not a physical temperature ceiling. Dry N_2/O_2 coefficients extend to 20000 K. Ground-state ideal Ar has constant heat capacity and no finite polynomial ceiling, but this does not suppress excitation, ionization or nonideal effects in real argon. Accepted paths do not switch composition or extrapolate coefficients.

Gas	F (J/m^2)	T_{obs} (K)	T_{global} (K)	M_{max}	Status
air wet	0	6000	*undefined*	0.6361	gas coefficient upper boundary
air wet	10	6000	*undefined*	0.6361	gas coefficient upper boundary
air wet	100	6000	*undefined*	0.6361	gas coefficient upper boundary
air dry	0	6263.58	6263.58	0.6338	completed
air dry	100	6263.58	6263.58	0.6338	completed
argon dry	0	22808.7	22808.7	0.2253	completed
argon dry	100	22808.7	22808.7	0.2253	completed

Table 3: Formal 1.3 bar cases with prescribed confinement. Wet pulses use the nominal minus 5 microsecond offset; dry F=100 cases use minus 1 microsecond relative to their own no-laser reference. These protocols do not isolate a composition-only effect. Missing global values are not a temperature ceiling.

The 1.3 bar cases are always formal. A small or moderate maximum wall Mach alone would not establish first-order KM accuracy. Negative far-field absolute pressure, strong compressibility, shocks and nonsphericity can require a different flow model. Fixed high-temperature composition, constant gas conductivity, omitted evaporation/condensation and latent heat further limit the temperatures.

Local material safety cannot be inferred from a smeared source. In the matched static comparisons, the MR7 radial model predicts peak Au temperature rises of only approximately 21–30% of the resolved finite-Au MR6 values. Agreement in integrated gas-energy delivery (differences of about 0.04–1.68%) does not validate the local Au temperature field. Consequently, material thresholds in MR7 are diagnostic references and cannot establish physical admissibility of nanoparticle heating, melting, or nearby phase transitions. This static discrepancy is not a universal error bound for the moving model, whose local field is not resolved.

Bulk gold melting and water boiling temperatures are not universal nanoparticle damage or nucleation thresholds. A primary experiment on 90 nm-diameter Au with 5 ns pulses found a 532 nm vapor-bubble threshold near 600 ± 50 J/m^2 [5]. Its size, support, pulse and observable differ from this study; it supplies no calibrated cutoff for the present acoustic bubble.

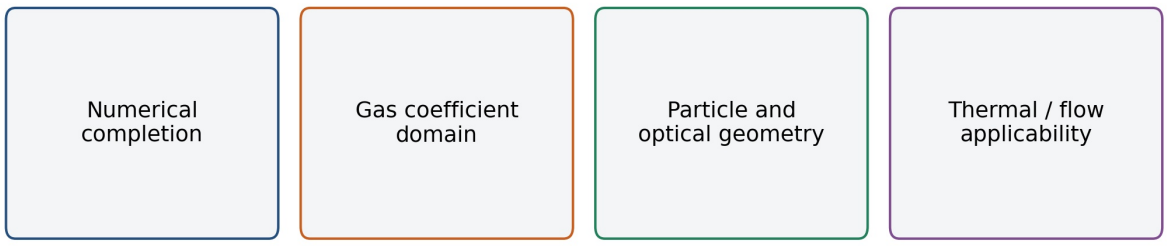


Figure 8: Separate numerical completion, coefficient domain, geometry and physical-model screens. Formal and censored values remain visible.

11 What this calculation establishes

For the declared 10 J/m^2, 10 ns pulse and prescribed confinement, the stable 1 bar pair has 1.4088 microkelvin global change, the stable 1.15 bar pair has 2.1849 microkelvin global change, the 1.3 bar pair is censored and has no defined five-cycle temperature change. The 1.00 bar result is conditional on the reduced model and unverified confinement. The numerically completed 1.15 bar result is a formal fixed-composition scenario; it is not a validated physical gas state. The timing scan retains pulses that miss the selected thermal maximum. The temperature differences describe the specified reduced equations, with source averaging and mechanical feedback explicitly included or separated; they are not experimentally achieved temperature gains.

Heat must first leave gold, diffuse through moving water and cross the signed gas boundary. The source has memory, so absorbed energy is neither instantaneous gas heat nor a geometry-independent transfer fraction. Pressure feedback can amplify or reduce the one-way response by altering the compression path; it must be measured from matched models rather than assumed beneficial. At 1 bar the initial net wall-flux increment peaks 38.6 ns after the pulse center, within the declared 2 microsecond window. The first-cycle thermal maximum follows the center by 2.459 microseconds; its temperature increment at the reference time is 0.9523 microkelvin. At 1.15 bar the initial net wall-flux increment peaks 34.9 ns after the pulse center, within the declared 2 microsecond window. The first-cycle thermal maximum follows the center by 5 microseconds; its temperature increment at the reference time is 2.185 microkelvin. The net flux increment includes changed gas cooling and compression feedback; it is not a laser-tagged energy fraction.

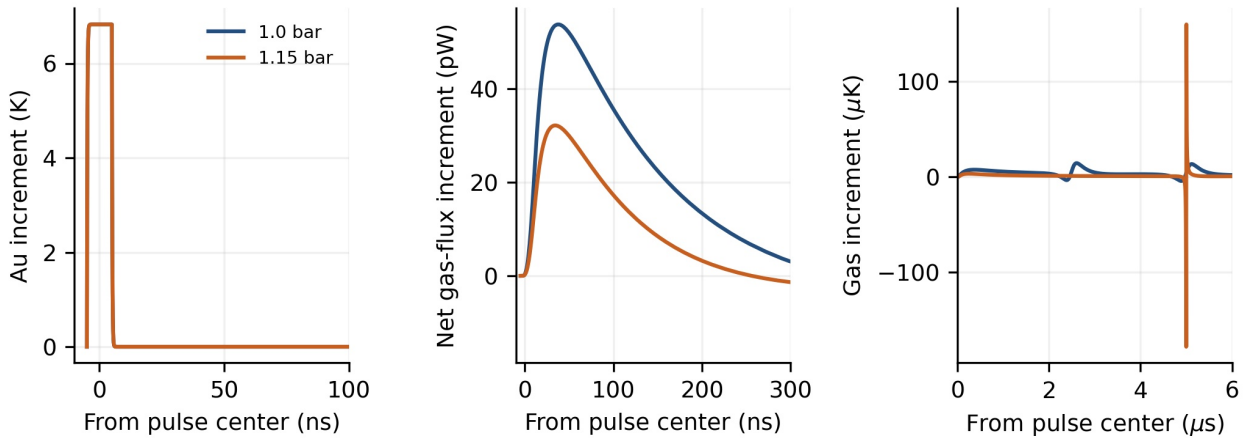


Figure 9: Finite paired increments for the nominal pulse: Au storage, net gas-boundary power and gas temperature. Transient temperature differences can exceed the difference of separately maximized temperatures when the compression path shifts. The power increment includes feedback; it is not a tagged photon-delivery fraction.

The strongest remaining uncertainty is physical reduction. A local finite particle has an angularly concentrated thermal environment, whereas the present source fills a spherical shell. The static comparisons quantify selected observable discrepancies, not a universal bound on moving near-contact error. A resolved moving axisymmetric calculation with finite Au surfaces, consistent compressible flow where needed, and explicit contact/phase treatment is the next targeted test. A reacting gas would require species balances, a consistent EOS derivative and formation/ionization energy on the same timescale; adding high-temperature coefficients alone is insufficient.

These results form a reproducible reduced-model study. They do not establish a realizable maximum gas temperature, plasma state or thermonuclear yield.

A Numerical controls and reproducibility

The state uses scaled radius, speed, temperatures and thermal ledgers. BDF is the production stiff solver; representative Radau runs provide an independent method. Pulse edges split integration intervals exactly. Source weights and geometric conductances are updated at every evaluation. A finite beam allowance is applied to the local particle count, with no repeated layer absorption. The liquid field is represented in fixed material cells; all plotted radial profiles explicitly mean spherical averages.

Control	T_{max} (K)	t_T (μs)	R_{min} (μm)	dT/dF (μK)	Residual
coarse	553.02546	147.13187	4.434281	0.142346	2.44e-08
production	553.02304	147.13186	4.43429	0.140888	5.62e-08
fine	553.0243	147.13186	4.434277	0.14047	1.82e-07
outer50	553.02286	147.13186	4.434293	0.140974	1.26e-07
strict	553.02567	147.13187	4.434267	0.1408	9.3e-10
Radau	553.02571	147.13187	4.434266	0.140798	9.56e-12
step half	553.02344	147.13186	4.434291	0.140856	5.93e-08

Table 4: Independent numerical controls at 1.0 bar. The derivative unit is microkelvin per J/m^2.

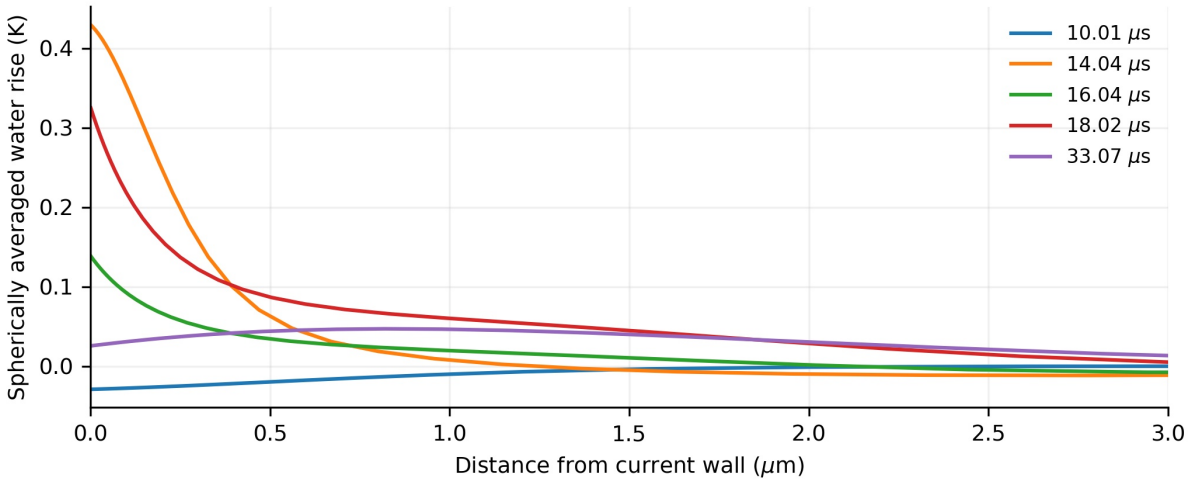


Figure 10: Radial material-water temperatures at selected times, expressed at their current physical radii. Each curve is a spherical average; no local two-dimensional Au field is implied.

B Physical scales omitted by the frozen mixture

P_a (bar)	Gas	p_{max} (MPa)	$\rho_{g,max}$ (kg/m^3)	R/c_g (ns)	Width (ns)
1	air wet	0.56365	3.6564	9.612	406
1.15	air wet	129.56	159.53	1.234	17.86
1.3	air wet	2014.9	1157.1	0.4389	*undefined*
1.3	air dry	2276.7	1261.2	0.4195	3.232
1.3	argon dry	396.55	83.533	0.6207	7.03

Table 5: Ideal-EOS diagnostics, not measured material states. The width is reconstructed from saved samples and is undefined when an observed peak lacks a right-hand half-height crossing.

The ideal-EOS peak pressure reaches about 2 GPa and gas density exceeds 1000 kg/m^3 before wet 1.3 bar censoring. The gas sound-crossing estimate being shorter than a reconstructed thermal width is only a timescale screen; it

cannot establish a uniform, nonreacting, ideal gas at such states. The censored wet peak has no complete width.

Separate standard-state reference demands use inherited formation/ionization data and water phase enthalpies [6]. For the wet 1.3 bar inventory, full water dissociation to 2H+O has an energy scale of 8.01×10^{-10} J, about 10.4% of its observed frozen-gas sensible increment; O_2 dissociation has a scale of 62.2%. At 1.15 bar the corresponding ratios are 26.0% and 154%. The dry-Ar first-ionization threshold for the entire inventory is about 5.41 times its frozen peak sensible increment. These overlapping reference processes are not added together, are not inferred reaction fractions and do not recompute temperatures. High-pressure phase enthalpy, equilibrium or kinetic extents and consistent EOS derivatives require a separate reacting/phase model.

C Sources and independent limits

The optical and gas inputs are those of the accepted earlier studies; no new free parameter is calibrated against a peak temperature. The experimental reference [5] concerns laser-induced vapor bubbles around nanoparticles, not thermometry of the present acoustically driven gas. No matched experimental trajectory with all acoustic, composition, optical and particle-placement parameters is available here.

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